

Salted mangoes and cucumber

Activity 3

Cut a lemon into two. On one half, add some salt and leave the other as it is. Leave it aside for a week. Note the changes.

Sodium chloride preserves the food by the following principles:

- It causes the high osmotic pressure and hence plasmolysis occurs.
- It dehydrates foods by drawing out and tying up moisture, as it dehydrates microbial cell.
- It ionizes to yield the chlorine ion which is harmful to organisms.
- It reduces the solubility of oxygen in the moisture.
- It sensitizes the cell against carbon dioxide.
- It interferes with the action of proteolytic enzymes.

Pickling:

In pickling, food is placed in edible liquids like brine, vinegar or vegetable oil which inhibit or kill microorganisms. Sometimes, food is heated along with pickling agent so that it gets saturated with it.

Pickles may be broadly divided into three groups:

Sweet pickles e.g., tomato sweet pickle, mango sweet pickle.

Sour pickles e.g., mango pickle, lime pickle.

Fermented pickles e.g., cucumber pickle, cabbage pickle, chilli pickle, meat and sausages.

The important preservative agents in pickles are salt, vinegar, sugar, oil, spices and condiments. Each has a specific role in preservation.



Mango pickle



Lemon pickle

Chapter 4_070-087.indd 82 31-03-2018 13:21:41